

The Eiffel Tower

The Eiffel Tower is a wrought-iron lattice tower on the Champ de Mars in Paris, France. It is named after the engineer Gustave Eiffel, whose company designed and built the tower. Construction began in 1887 and the tower was completed in 1889, in time to serve as the entrance to the 1889 World's Fair, which celebrated the centennial of the French Revolution.

The tower is 330 metres tall, about the same height as an 81-storey building. When it was finished it was the tallest man-made structure in the world, a title it held for 41 years until the Chrysler Building in New York City was completed in 1930.

The tower has three levels open to visitors, with restaurants on the first and second levels. The top level's upper platform is 276 metres above the ground. Visitors can climb the stairs to the second level or take one of the lifts. Around seven million people visit the Eiffel Tower every year, making it one of the most visited paid monuments in the world.